

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, September 24, 2025, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor William Greenrose
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Nancy Bates, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

Remove Amtrack – moved to later in October.

Matteau motion to suspend council rules to add an item to the agenda.

Voice Vote:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway – Yes

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – No

Girard – Yes

Motion carried 8-1

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Discus new business – 13 Edgewood St

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to accept the minutes of the September 2, 2025, City Council meeting.

Voice Vote:

**Koloski – Yes
Greenrose – Yes
Limoges - Yes
Matteau – Yes
Zutter – Yes
Hemingway – Yes
Hayden – Yes
O’Hearne – Yes
Girard – Yes
Motion carried 9-0**

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Zutter to accept the minutes of the September 10, 2025, City Council meeting.

Voice Vote:

**Koloski – Yes
Greenrose – Yes
Limoges - Yes
Matteau – Yes
Zutter – Yes
Hemingway – Yes
Hayden – Yes
O’Hearne – Yes
Girard – Yes
Motion carried 9-0**

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MAYOR'S NOTES

City election –Tuesday, November 4th – filings close on Friday 5:00pm.

Saturday September 27th Claremont Soup Kitchen will be hosting their fall breakfast from 7:30am -11:00am.

Saturday and Sunday Sullivan County UNH extension will be hosting Sullivan County Farm days from 10:00am – 4:00pm, Information can be found on the city calendar.
Eastern Collegiate race is also taking place this weekend Saturday and Sunday taking place at Arrowhead and Moody Park.

Claremont Parks and Recreation & The Chamber of Commerce will hold the annual fall festival and chili cook off on Saturday October 4th 10:00am – 3:00pm at the Visitor Center.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

The city has yet to receive the June technical report for the Visitor Center.

October 1st at 5:00pm a ribbon cutting will take place for the pickleball and tennis courts at Veterans Park.

Verbal confirmation of acceptance for the Planning Director has been given.

17 Water St project moving forward and the city has received the first deposit.

Koloski inquired if it would be possible to get more information in our packet that is more than a quote on the pool. Manager Bates will bring forward more information at a later date to the Council.

Councilor Koloski mentioned the graffiti issue that damaged several places in the city; Councilor Koloski asked that the city post on social media to make the public aware if their residence or business was affected, they should reach out to the police department.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

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Mayor Girard opened at 6:41.

Tom Luther Ward 1 – Mr. Luther came to commend the 311 program – this program allows you to take a picture of items that need to be taken care of around the city and sent to the correct department. The program works very well, Mr. Luther Stated.

City Manager Bates did say

Mayor Girard closed 6:44pm.

OLD BUSINESS

AMTRACK Train Station Presentation

AMTRACK Train presentation moved to a later meeting in October

NEW BUSINESS

13 Edgewood St.

Councilor Koloski raises concerns about the process.

Manager Bates stated this is owner occupied only; the city can order to vacate if it is a rental, cannot with owner occupied; thus, why it is different. He was given a certain timeline to take care of this issue. He states that this issue has been going on for years.

Chief Building Inspector Thibodeau explained the issue of violation was to cut his grass and do an inspection. Inspector Thibodeau shared the violations that were found and asked for the Council permission to move in corrective order.

Mayor Girard – the inspector just did the inspection yesterday and the Manager Bates just received the order today shortly before the meeting.

Councilor Limoges shared that when driving by the property himself he agrees the condition looks bad.

Assistant Mayor Matteau questions if the fix will be on the city's nickel and what are we expecting for expenses.

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Chief Building Inspector Thibodeau estimates the city will be looking at 10-20 thousand in cost.

Councilor Greenrose confirms the payment of the structural fixes will become a tax lien.

Councilor O'Hearn inquired if the owner had been notified and when.

Chief Building Inspector confirms Matt Decker is the attorney working on this.

Manager Bates confirms the recommendation is in writing.

Councilor Koloski states he is not prepared to move on this tonight due to just receiving the information.

Councilor Greenrose is concerned due to the property owner not having even received his notification yet, as it was just sent out in the mail today.

Councilor Zutter stated we have just talked about how this has been a problem for 5 years and it would be shortsighted on our part to not act on this now.

Assistant Mayor Matteau asks for clarification that the owner could refuse to allow us on his property, correct?

Chief Building Inspector Thibodeau responded yes.

Councilor Hemingway states he has the same feeling of not acting on this tonight.

Mayor Girard asks for clarification that the city currently does not have a court order, this is the process to get the court order.

Chief Building Inspector confirms yes this is correct.

Councilor O'Hearn inquired if the notice was based on the RSA.

Chief Building Inspector responds yes.

Councilor O'Hearn inquires why the notice could not be delivered by a police officer.

Chief Building Inspector explains the notice needed to be approved.

Manager Bates explains the owner received a 16-page violation; this is not a kneejerk reaction we have been dealing with this property for quite some time.

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Councilor Hayden inquired if 30 days is enough time to get a contractor over to the property by the owner.

Chief Building Inspector Thibodeau wanted to clarify why we are here tonight – this is for if the work is not completed within 30 days.

Councilor O’Hearne stated he feels he would rather have an emergency meeting with the attorney here once we know the owner has received his notice.

Mayor explained what Manager Bates is asking for is to be able to start the 30-day window, nothing more. From the pictures we saw tonight this is a dangerous situation.

Councilor Zutter made a motion to table 13 Edgewood St. discussion and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau. The motion was not read so the council is unable to table.

Manager Bates stated she will remove the discussion from tonight and bring it back;
Schedule a meeting for Tuesday September 30th or if the room is not available it will be Monday, September 29th.

A. White Water Update (City Manager/Director of Public Works)

Director Gleeson explained the dam has been under review for the last 2 years.

Mr. Jason Gallant is here to make a presentation. See PowerPoint in council packet.

Mayor Girard asked for confirmation there is no imminent danger, the dam needs some repairs to bring it back up to standard.

Councilor Limoges asked for confirmation that the dam is safe.

Mayor Girard asked Manager Bates where would this money come from
This is part of our drinking water supply – so there is option

Director Gleeson explained we are looking for permission to accept the \$60,000 from the state;
this does expire 12/31/27

A brief discussion followed.

B. Resolution 2026-17 Lead Service Line Inventory Grant – Public Hearing (City Manager/Director of Public Works)

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RESOLUTION 2026-17

Lead Service and Line Sampling and Replacement Plan Grant

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City of Claremont has recently been awarded funding through the Large Public Water System Lead Service Line Inventory (LSLI) Grant Program administered by the New Hampshire Department of Environmental Services (NHDES) Drinking Water and Groundwater Bureau (DWGB); and

WHEREAS the City would like to accept the LSLI grant funds for their intended purpose;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED to raise and appropriate up to \$60,000.00 to be funded by the LSLI Grant Program to support efforts to identify the material composition of service lines that were listed as “unknown” in the initial lead service line inventory; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or her designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution. (2/3 *Vote Required*)

Dated this 24th day of September 2025, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing at 7:49pm - no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed public hearing at 7:49pm.

A motion was made by Councilor Zutter and seconded by Councilor Koloski to accept resolution 2016-17. Resolution was read into the record by Councilor Zutter.

Voice vote:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway – Yes

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – Yes

Girard – Yes

Motion carried 9-0

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15 Minute Break @ 7:51pm
Back 8:01pm

C. Claremont Youth Baseball Softball Association Discussion on Updates at Monadnock Park Youth Baseball and Softball Fields (City Manager/Parks and Recreation Director)

Director Martin introduced President and Vice-President of CYSA.

Secretary – Racquel spoke about the grant these are requirements mandated by Bath Ruth/Cal Ripken.

Mrs. D'Aloia stated right now our fields are 40/60 and they want us to move to 50/70. They will be convertible fields. Our goal right now is with your approval to get field 2 done. We have other issues that need to be addressed as well. Asetex has donated to replace out scoreboard. Parks & rec did help with the grant but the money was awarded to CYBSA

Councilor Hemingway asked if you have until 2027 what is the rush now.

D'Aloia stated a couple of reasons – we would have to delay getting the grant funds and we host a tournament annually.

Councilor Koloski mentioned when you have someone donate money to put a new mound in and now that is going to be torn up. If this does proceed, we must get more bids.

Councilor Hemingway echo's the mayor's feelings – but wanted to thank them for what they do for the community and the kids.

Councilor Hayden asked where they money is coming from for the fencing.

Racquel stated they have received offers to sponsor a field in return for fixing fencing. She also stated the fill out and sod that was brought in for the field last year was the first time in a very long time that anything besides lining and mowing has been done to the fields.

Councilor Hayden asked about the impact of other spots.

D. Claremont Arts, History and Culture Resources Preservation Commission- City Inventory (City Manager/ Felicia Brych Dalke)

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There were many people that helped put this list together. The list is already outdated as we continue to find things.

Councilor Zutter, thanked Mrs. Dalke for the list and asked what falls into the other category.

Mrs. Dalke responded, a sign in the Police Department and historic maps

Councilor Greenrose felt this is a great list.

Councilor Limoges asked about the wall and mentioned the wall being listed.

Councilor Koloski inquired if we should share this list with our insurance company.

Manager Bates stated Primex does not put a value on something that does not have a value listed.

Councilor Zutter would like to see about artifact from Arrowhead.

Mrs. Dalke talked about the display currently at the Visitor's Center Building, please stop by and see it. We have also established a budget to restore the original eagle, currently on display in the atrium. She does believe that raising funds is within the committee scope but would like clarification from the council.

Councilor Koloski said he does view this committee the same as the 250th committee and does agree that it is within the scope to collecting funds.

Asked about what the cost to restore the eagle would be.

Mrs. Dalke stated it is \$550 just to get someone to look at it. Budgeting \$4,000 for 1st phase

There was a census that the fundraising is ok.

A city employee is on our board and makes sure all is complying.

E. Fee Schedule – Public Hearing (City Manager)

A presentation was given regarding Building Permit Fees.

In the last 25 years inflation has increased 88% and since 2020 22% and we have not increased our fees to keep up with the times.

Councilor Kolski stated he is in favor of the proposed increases.

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Councilor Hayden also stated he is also in favor of the increases.

Director Gleeson spoke about the desire to offer Metered Hydrant Connection with a rate of \$.078 per cubic ft based on current 1,001 to 50,000 cu ft fee and a connection fee of \$150.00.

Councilor Limoges inquired if the \$150.00 is that for every day they want to get water.

Councilor Greenrose asked for confirmation if we have the right to refuse service, for example when there is a drought.

Councilor Kolski would like to match what Lebanon is charging which is \$0.13.

Councilor Hayden stated the \$0.78 charge is what the current water charge is.

Mayor Girard agrees with Koloski that we need to be more in line with surrounding communities.

Manager Bates stated that we do not have the tool to prevent backflow.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to approve the Building Permit Fees as presented.

Open public hearing no on spoke. Public hearing was closed.

Voice vote:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway – Yes

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – Yes

Girard – Yes

Motion carried 9-0

F. Tax deeded Property List (City Manager/City Clerk)

Motion to Refuse Tax Deed

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The City Council, having reviewed the list of impending tax deed parcels as presented by the City's Tax Collector, hereby notifies the Tax Collector that she shall not execute a deed of the real estate to the City for the following parcels because the Council has determined in its judgment that acceptance would subject the City to undesirable obligations or liability risks, including the potential liability as an owner of property under state and federal law, which imposes strict liability on owners for environmental impairment of the real estate involved:

PAYMENT AGREEMENTS

27 CHASE ST	132-154
96 CHESTNUT ST	132-117
5 RAYMOND PL	158-25
92 RED WATER BRK RD	58-8
17 STEWART AVE	159-19
17 MADISON PL	57-21-17
9 MCCUSKER PL	57-27-82

MOBILE HOMES IN PARK

33 UPHAM PL	159-56-12
14 UPHAM PL	159-56-20

The City Council further authorizes the Tax Collector or other City official to enforce all such tax liens upon the above-listed properties, as provided by RSA 80:50 and through any other remedy provided by law.

A motion was made by Councilor O'Hearne and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to approve F. Tax Deeded Property List.

Voice vote:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – No

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway – Yes

Hayden – Yes

O'Hearne – Yes

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Girard – Yes
Motion carried 8-1

G. LWCF Residuals Discussion (City Manager/Director of Parks and Recreation)

Director Martin read the memo he provided to the council.

The grant expires September 30, 2025.

Councilor Zutter inquires what the difference is between simple bathroom and upgraded one.

Director Martin explained a simple would be just a bathroom probably block closed in the winter and upgraded would have storage and some picnic tables and shade area.

Manager Bates stated this is just a friendly conversation we have time so no decision needs to be made tonight.

Councilor Hayden asked for clarification on what the fee would be to resurface the parking area at Veteran's Park.

Director Martin stated he has been talking to the DPW Director and about options; they may be able to use the millings from the Washington St paving project.

The census from the council is they would like to see more information on bathhouse.

H. Claremont Development Authority Northern Borders Grant Discussion (City Manager/CDA)

Mrs. Maki was present chair of the finance committee for the CDA, explained she is here to present A 20% match and to ask for the best option for use to get the needed funds see (page 2).

Mayor Giard noted that two years ago the bylaws were changed and that is why the CDA is coming before us. He spoke with the CDA chair earlier and he believes the best thing right now is for the city to transfer funds with stipulations.

Assistant Mayor Matteau asked if we would be transferring the money the day, they are getting ready to pay a bill.

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Manager Bates stated she would just transfer the entire amount at once, this would be too much staff time to pay as bills come in. We will not lose that much interest.

It was a census of the council that Manager bates will come back with a resolution.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Greenrose –stated the board did lose one of their members we have just enough for a quorum right now.

Councilor Limoges – CDA – demolition should have started today.

Councilor Hayden – missed the conservation commission.

Councilor O’Hearne – hired a site manager at the Tolles home.

Mayor Girard – Airport has not met; the airport will shut down on October 1.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

None

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

ADJOURNMENT

At 10:18 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adjourn.

Voice vote:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

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Hemingway – Yes
Hayden – Yes
O’Hearne – Yes
Girard – Yes
Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Jaime DeRosa
Clerk to the Council

Gwendolyn Melcher
City Clerk